CRISIS PLAYBOOK · NO. 02

WEEK OF 16 NOVEMBER 2026

- T+00:00 Incident declared
- T+00:02 Alert sent · push, SMS, voice
- T+01:30 Escalated · no response
- T+04:10 Team acknowledged



PROPERTY, HOUSING AND FACILITIES

Every resident reached.

Fire, flood, gas, a dead lift or a building system that stops obeying. A playbook for reaching every resident, occupier and member of staff in the first hour, including the people who cannot leave on their own.

T+00:00 · T+00:05 · T+00:15 · T+01:00 · T+04:00

INSIDE

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A practical playbook for landlords, managing agents and facilities teams: how to keep residents, occupiers and staff safe and informed when a building emergency starts, and how to prove afterwards that you did.

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FOREWORD

In a building emergency, the message is part of the safety system.

When something goes wrong in a block of flats, an office or a care setting, the physical response gets the attention: the fire service, the engineer, the shut-off valve. Yet the Grenfell Tower Inquiry found that the people affected were also failed by information. The landlord's records of residents who might need help to escape were incomplete on the night, and in the days after the fire the council had no effective system for communicating with the public.[1,2]

The law has moved since. Responsible persons in multi-occupied residential buildings must give residents fire safety instructions and report lift faults to the fire service. From April 2026, taller buildings and those that have switched to simultaneous evacuation need evacuation plans for residents who cannot get out unaided. Social landlords now have 24 hours to investigate and make safe emergency hazards.[3,4,5]

There is a newer risk too. In October and November 2026, attackers reached refrigeration controllers across Europe that had been left exposed to the internet, and the UK's National Cyber Security Centre warned that other building and heating controls could be at risk if left unprotected.[6,7] A building management system that is switched off, or quietly changed, is now a credible way for an emergency to begin.

This playbook is for the people who own that first hour: housing and property managers, facilities and building safety leads, and the out-of-hours teams who pick up the phone at 3am. It is practical and vendor-neutral. Our companion intelligence report sets out the evidence and the legal detail.

The Crises Control team
Crises Control

INTRODUCTION

Three things decide whether everyone is reached.

Most failures in building emergencies are not about knowing what to do. They are about who knows, how fast they hear, and whether anyone can show later what was decided and why.

Know who is in the building

A current, consented record of residents and occupiers who may need help, with how each prefers to be contacted and who can act for them.

Reach them in minutes, not hours

Pre-approved messages for each kind of emergency, sent on more than one channel, with a way to see who has not acknowledged.

Log every decision

A single, timestamped record of what was known, what was decided, who was told and when. It protects residents first and your organisation second.

A plan that cannot reach the person on the ninth floor is not a plan.

Evacuation strategies, contractor rotas and BMS alarms all depend on one thing working: getting the right instruction to the right person, and knowing that it arrived.

PART 01

Know your building.

Before the alarm sounds: the emergencies you will face, how serious each one is, who lives inside and who decides.

01 Why building emergencies are communication emergencies

02 Six emergencies, six first messages

03 A severity ladder and an escalation route

04 Knowing who needs help

05 A resident assistance register

06 Who does what: a responsibility matrix

KNOW YOUR BUILDING

Why building emergencies are communication emergencies

> **The physical emergency is only half of it. Who knows, how fast, and what they do next usually decides the harm.**

Every building emergency has two parts. One is physical: a fire, a burst main, a gas escape, a stuck lift, a power cut. The other is informational: who needs to know, what they should do, and whether they have understood.

The Grenfell Tower Inquiry's findings are blunt on this. The landlord's emergency plan was out of date and incomplete, missing fire action notices were a prominent subject of residents' complaints, and its information on vulnerable residents was incomplete on the night.[1] Afterwards, the council had no arrangements for identifying those forced from their homes or for communicating with them.[1]

Residents also notice when communication fails in ordinary times. In its review of complaints determined in 2025-26, the Housing Ombudsman found poor communication and inadequate record keeping running through its most serious repairs cases.[8]

The building itself is changing too. Heating, ventilation, lifts, access and pumps are increasingly run from a building management system (BMS) that a contractor can reach remotely. In October 2026 France's CERT-FR reported numerous compromises of internet-exposed refrigeration controllers.[6] US agencies warned such attacks could alter settings and create fire hazards.[9]

No UK building management system compromise was confirmed in that wave, but the NCSC has warned that exposed controls of other kinds are at risk.[7] For elderly residents, heating switched off on a January night is a welfare emergency, whatever caused it.

So the planning question is not only how to fight a fire or fix a pipe. It is how quickly you can tell everyone what to do, and how you will know who has not heard.

SIX EMERGENCIES

Six emergencies, and what the first message must say

The first message sets the tone for everything after it. Agree the wording now, not on the night.

EMERGENCY	FIRST MESSAGE MUST SAY	WATCH FOR
Fire	Where it is, the current strategy and how to report a fire, matching the instructions residents already hold.[3]	A change of strategy. The second message matters more than the first.
Flood or escape of water	Which floors are affected, whether to isolate electrics, where to go if homes are unsafe.	Water reaching risers, lift pits and electrical intakes.
Gas	No switches or flames, open windows, leave if told to, call 0800 111 999.[10]	Residents who cannot leave quickly.
Lift failure	Which lifts are out, expected return, help for those who cannot use stairs.	In high-rise blocks, report firefighting lift faults not fixed in 24 hours to the fire service.[3]
Power failure	Scope, expected duration, what still works, welfare checks for powered medical equipment.	Door entry and warden call that depend on mains power.
BMS fault or tampering	What people will notice (heat, ventilation, access), what to report, and that the cause is being checked.	Settings that change back after a reset.

SEVERITY

A severity ladder for buildings

Agree the levels in advance so the person on call does not have to decide alone. Each level names who is alerted and how.

SEV 1

Life at risk

TRIGGERS

Fire with smoke spreading, change from stay put to evacuation, gas escape inside the building, people trapped, structural movement, or, for social landlords, an emergency hazard under Awaab's Law.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Duty manager, building safety lead, senior leadership, every affected resident, contractors and the fire and rescue service liaison.

`Voice + SMS + push, repeat until acknowledged`

SEV 2

Safety at risk

TRIGGERS

Firefighting or evacuation lift out with no fix in 24 hours, loss of heating in cold weather, flood affecting electrics, unexplained BMS changes.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Duty manager, building safety lead, contractor, residents of affected floors, welfare team for vulnerable residents.

`SMS + push + email, voice for vulnerable residents`

SEV 3

Service disruption

TRIGGERS

Single lift out with another working, planned shutdown overrun, door entry fault, local leak contained.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Duty manager, contractor, affected residents or occupiers.

`SMS or push + email`

SEV 4

Monitor

TRIGGERS

BMS alarm cleared, minor fault logged, advance notice of works.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Building team and contractor; residents only if they will notice.

`Email or app notice`

ESCALATION

Who is alerted, who decides, and when it goes up

An illustrative escalation route tied to the severity ladder. Each level names a decision owner, so nobody at 3am waits for permission that is not coming.

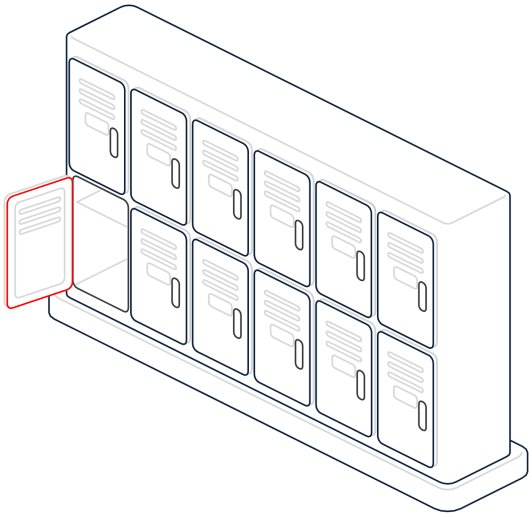
	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 1 **Building report**	A caretaker, concierge, resident or BMS alarm reports a fault or hazard. Usually SEV 4 or 3.	Out-of-hours line and building team; the contractor if a repair is needed.	Duty manager on call, who sets the severity level.
↓ ESCALATE IF NOT ACKNOWLEDGED IN 10 MINUTES, OR RESIDENTS' SAFETY MAY BE AFFECTED			
LEVEL 2 **Duty manager**	SEV 2: firefighting lift out, heating lost in cold weather, flood near electrics, unexplained BMS changes.	Duty manager, building safety lead, contractor, residents of affected floors, welfare lead.	Duty manager, with the building safety lead.
↓ ESCALATE IF LIFE IS AT RISK, SEVERAL BLOCKS ARE AFFECTED, OR RESIDENTS MUST LEAVE			
LEVEL 3 **Incident control**	SEV 1: fire, gas escape, people trapped, a change to evacuation, or several blocks affected at once.	Incident lead, head of housing or facilities, every affected resident, communications, fire service liaison.	Incident lead. The fire and rescue service decides the evacuation strategy.
↓ ESCALATE IF A REST CENTRE IS NEEDED, SOMEONE IS BADLY HURT, OR THE MEDIA CALL			
LEVEL 4 **Executive**	A prolonged SEV 1, residents displaced overnight, serious injury, or regulator and media scrutiny.	Executive director, accountable person, board chair, insurers, council emergency planning.	Executive director, who also owns reports to regulators, including any safety occurrence.

Escalation is triggered by conditions, not by someone remembering to call. If a level has not acknowledged within its time limit, the next level is alerted automatically and the delay is recorded.

WHO LIVES HERE

Four things to know about every resident who may need help

The law requires this in blocks of 18 metres or seven storeys, and over 11 metres with simultaneous evacuation. It helps everywhere.[4]



01 **Who and where**

Residents whose ability to evacuate is compromised by an impairment or condition, with flat and floor.[4]

02 **What help they need**

Offer a person-centred fire risk assessment; agree the approach in an emergency evacuation statement.[4]

03 **How to reach them**

Preferred channel and language, and whether a carer should also be told.

04 **Consent and review**

Share with the fire service only with explicit consent. Review every 12 months.[4]

TEMPLATE

Resident assistance register

One row for each resident who may need help to leave or to stay safe at home. In buildings in scope, offer a person-centred fire risk assessment, agree an emergency evacuation statement and review it every 12 months.[4]

BLOCK, FLOOR, FLAT	RESIDENT	HELP NEEDED	CONTACT CHANNEL AND LANGUAGE	CARER OR NAMED CONTACT	CONSENT TO SHARE WITH FIRE SERVICE	NEXT REVIEW
Block B, floor 9, flat 9.04	*Initials only*	*Wheelchair user; cannot use stairs. Evacuation statement agreed.*	*Voice call in Polish; SMS copy to daughter*	*Daughter, mobile on file*	*Yes, recorded 12 March 2026*	*March 2027*

Illustrative example row. Health details are sensitive: record only what an emergency needs and limit who can see the register. Add residents with powered medical equipment, hearing or sight loss, and those who do not read English, even where no evacuation plan is required. Keep a current copy available out of hours and away from the office.

ROLES

Who does what in a building emergency

Illustrative, for a landlord or managing agent. One person is accountable for each activity; adapt the roles and keep the matrix with the on-call rota.

ACTIVITY	DUTY MANAGER	BUILDING SAFETY LEAD	HEAD OF HOUSING	WELFARE LEAD	COMMS	CONTRACTORS
Open the incident and set the severity level	A	C	I	I	I	·
Send the first message to residents	A	C	·	I	C	·
Relay a change of evacuation strategy to every resident	A	R	I	I	I	·
Give the fire service plans and the consented assistance list	C	A	·	R	·	·
Reach residents with assistance needs and report each status	I	C	·	A	·	·
Chase residents who have not acknowledged	A	·	·	R	·	I
Call out contractors; approve any remote BMS, lift or alarm change	A	C	·	·	·	R
Arrange a rest centre or temporary accommodation	R	·	A	R	I	·
Issue the holding statement and media updates	C	·	A	·	R	·
Decide whether a safety occurrence must be reported	I	R	A	·	·	·
Keep the decision log and lead the post-incident review	R	A	I	C	C	C

R Responsible: does the work · A Accountable: owns the decision · C Consulted · I Informed

> The fire and rescue service decides the evacuation strategy; this matrix covers how you carry it out. Statutory duty-holders keep their legal duties whatever you delegate.

PART 02

The first hour.

When the alarm sounds: who does what, what residents hear, how silence is chased and how to change course safely.

01 A worst-day timeline

02 Ready-to-send messages

03 Changing the evacuation strategy

04 When residents do not respond

05 Three blocks, one night

06 Three scenarios

WORST DAY

Fire in a high-rise block, 02:10 on a winter night

Illustrative: a 20-storey block with a stay-put strategy and residents who need help to leave. Adapt the roles to your structure.

CLOCK	ACTION	OWNER
T+00:00	**Fire reported, 999 called** A resident calls 999 and the out-of-hours line. The incident is opened; duty manager and building safety lead alerted automatically.	OUT-OF-HOURS
T+00:08	**First message to residents** Approved message to every resident: location, current strategy, how to report smoke. SMS, push and voice.	DUTY MANAGER
T+00:12	**Information for the fire service** Plans and secure information box confirmed. Consented list of residents who need help ready for the incident commander.	BUILDING SAFETY LEAD
T+00:20	**Strategy change** If the fire service decides to evacuate, one message goes to all residents at once. Non-acknowledgements are chased.	DUTY MANAGER
T+00:30	**Vulnerable residents** Each resident on the list is reached, or reported to the incident commander as not reached.	WELFARE LEAD
T+00:45	**Contractors, holding line, log** Lift, alarm and BMS contractors called; no remote changes without approval. Holding statement issued. Log checked.	FACILITIES AND COMMS

TEMPLATES

Six messages to approve before you need them

Short, specific and written for the person reading at 2am. Keep SMS under 160 characters and send the same instruction on every channel.

SMS · RESIDENTS — 133 chars

> FIRE at Lowry House, floor 9. Stay in your flat unless fire or smoke affects it. If it does, get out and call 999. Updates to follow.

Only while the strategy is stay put.

SMS · OCCUPIERS AND STAFF — 130 chars

> Gas escape reported at Quay Building. Do not use switches or flames. Leave now by the nearest exit and meet at the front car park.

Fire wardens confirm floors are clear.

SMS · RESIDENTS — 132 chars

> Lowry House: LEAVE THE BUILDING NOW by the stairs. Do not use lifts. If you cannot get out, call 999 and tell them your flat number.

Strategy change. Voice call anyone who has not acknowledged.

EMAIL · CONTRACTORS

> Incident at Lowry House from 02:10. Make no remote changes to BMS, lift or alarm settings until the duty manager confirms. If on call, attend and report to the incident lead.

Stops resets that destroy evidence.

VOICE · VULNERABLE RESIDENTS

> This is Northgate Housing. There is a fire at Lowry House. The fire service know you may need help. Keep your front door shut and press 1 to confirm you heard this.

Only say the fire service know if they do.

HOLDING LINE · MEDIA AND FAMILIES

> We are working with the fire service at Lowry House. Residents' safety is our priority. We will update this statement at 04:00.

No speculation on cause or casualties.

STRATEGY CHANGE

Changing from stay put to evacuation

The decision belongs to the fire and rescue service. Your job is to make it reach every resident within minutes. The Grenfell Tower Inquiry criticised the absence of contingency plans for a full evacuation.[1]

Hear it once, clearly

Agree in advance how the incident commander's decision reaches your duty manager, and who is allowed to trigger the evacuation message.

Send to everyone, on every channel

One pre-approved instruction, by SMS, push and voice, to every resident and visitor on record. Building alarm systems where fitted.

Watch who has not responded

Non-acknowledgements are not silence. Pass the list of flats not reached to the incident commander, floor by floor.

Prioritise those who need help

Residents with evacuation statements are contacted individually and their status reported, using the information already shared with consent.

Log the change

Time of decision, time of message, numbers reached and not reached. This is the record an inquiry, regulator or court will ask for.

Test the strategy-change message at least once a year, with the fire safety instructions you give residents every 12 months.

NON-RESPONDERS

When residents do not acknowledge

Silence is not safety. Illustrative timings for a SEV 1 incident: set your own in the plan and agree with the fire service what they need from you, and when.

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER
T+0	First message on at least two channels, in the resident's recorded language where possible.	Duty manager
T+5 min	Automatic resend to everyone not yet acknowledged. Voice call at once to residents on the assistance register.	Duty manager monitors
T+10 min	Voice call to every remaining non-responder. Message the carer or named contact if one is recorded.	Welfare lead
T+15 min	List of flats not reached, by block and floor, to staff on site. Door-knocking only where safe and agreed with the fire service.	Caretaker or concierge
T+20 min	Flats still not reached, and any assistance-register resident not confirmed, passed to the incident commander.	Building safety lead
Until stand-down	Each flat marked reached, visited, passed to the fire service or confirmed away. Nobody leaves the list by assumption.	Welfare lead

TEMPLATE

Acknowledgement and follow-up log

For the duty manager and welfare lead during an incident: every flat that has not acknowledged, what was tried next and how it ended. Keep a printed copy for when power or systems fail.

TIME SENT	BLOCK AND FLAT	CHANNEL	ACKNOW-LEDGED	IF NOT: NEXT STEP AND TIME	DONE BY	OUTCOME
02:12	*B, 9.04*	*SMS and push*	*No*	*Voice call 02:17; door-knock 02:30*	*Caretaker*	*Reached 02:31; staying in flat with door shut*

Illustrative example row. Record the outcome for every flat, including those confirmed away from home, so the list passed to the fire service is accurate.

MULTI-BUILDING SCENARIO

Three blocks, one night

Illustrative: at 01:40 a fault in a shared plant room cuts power to Blocks A, B and C on one estate. Smoke is reported in Block B's basement. Lifts and door entry stop in all three.



> The red points are where nights like this usually fail: separate jobs instead of one incident, one message for three different situations, residents who depend on power, and evidence lost to a reset. Each has a named decision owner and a way of being monitored.

IN PRACTICE

Three buildings, three bad nights

SUPPORTED HOUSING, 40 FLATS

Burst tank floods the plant room at 23:00

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Power, lift and warden call fail together. Some residents use powered medical equipment.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Acknowledgement by flat; anyone silent after 15 minutes gets a call or a visit.

WHO DECIDES

The duty manager sets SEV 2, calls the welfare lead, contractor and network operator.

THE PROOF

Log shows every resident reached within 40 minutes. Know what fails when the power goes.

OFFICE CAMPUS, 1,200 STAFF

Heating and ventilation settings change overnight

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

BMS setpoints altered remotely; laboratory ventilation off. A quick reset would wipe the evidence.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Settings recorded before reset and checked hourly. A reset alone is not enough if the device stays exposed.[6]

WHO DECIDES

The head of facilities treats it as tampering, cuts remote access and approves any reset.

THE PROOF

Log and contractor access records shared with security and the insurer.

GENERAL NEEDS TOWER, 18 STOREYS

Both lifts fail on a Friday evening

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Residents with limited mobility stranded. One is the firefighting lift. By day two it is a welfare issue.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Daily calls to residents with limited mobility; the contractor's return date tracked as a task.

WHO DECIDES

The building safety lead owns the repair deadline and the fire service notification.

THE PROOF

Fire service told when the fault ran past 24 hours, and when fixed.[3] Monthly lift checks on record.

PART 03

Prove it.

After the first hour: contractors and nights, a record you can stand behind, the actions still open, and how to rehearse and review.

01 Who answers at 3am

02 A decision log you can defend

03 Tracking the actions that remain

04 A night-time tabletop exercise

05 A post-incident review template

06 Week, month, quarter

OUT OF HOURS

Who answers at 3am: five arrangements to settle now

Most building emergencies start outside office hours. The weakest link is usually the hand-off between your on-call team and a contractor's.

01 One number, one owner

A single out-of-hours route, a named duty manager and a deputy called automatically if the first does not respond.

02 Contractor contacts that work

Named 24/7 contacts for alarm, lift, BMS, gas, electrical and water contractors, tested quarterly.

03 Remote access rules

No remote changes during an incident without approval. Remote access only through secured connections.[6,9]

04 Information to hand

Floor plans and the consented list of residents who need help, available away from the office.[3,4]

05 Who reports to whom

Who tells the fire service, council and insurers, and who decides if a safety occurrence goes to the Building Safety Regulator.[11]

DECISION LOG

A decision log you can defend

Social landlords must now give tenants a written summary of investigation findings and keep them informed of progress.[5] A good log makes that easy.

AREA	WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Timing	Times reconstructed from memory and phone records days later.	Every alert, call and decision timestamped automatically as it happens.
Who was told	"We messaged the residents" with no list.	Recipients, channel, delivery and acknowledgement for every message.
Decisions	Actions recorded, reasons lost.	What was known, what was decided, by whom and why, in one place.
Vulnerable residents	A spreadsheet checked if someone remembers.	Each person's status recorded: reached, visited, passed to the fire service.
Contractors	Calls on personal phones, not recorded.	Who was called, when they arrived, what they changed.
Afterwards	A report written from scattered emails.	A timeline ready for the debrief, the Ombudsman or the regulator.

OUTSTANDING ACTIONS

The morning after: what is still open

Illustrative: the day after the three-block night incident. Review the board at every handover until each row is done, and escalate anything overdue or blocked.

ACTION	OWNER	DUE	STATUS	HOW IT IS CHECKED
Call every resident on the assistance register	Welfare lead	Day 1, 10:00	DONE	Status recorded for each resident
Written update to all residents of the three blocks	Comms	Day 1, 11:00	DONE	Delivery and acknowledgement by block
Secure plant room evidence and contractor access records	Facilities manager	Day 1, 12:00	DONE	Photos and records attached to the log
Restore power to Block B; test lifts and door entry	Electrical contractor	Day 1, 18:00	IN PROGRESS	Contractor sign-off in the incident record
Temporary heating for residents with medical needs	Housing officer	Day 1, 16:00	OVERDUE	Resident confirms delivery; escalated to duty manager
Make safe any emergency hazard in affected homes	Repairs manager	Day 2, 01:40	IN PROGRESS	Investigation and safety work logged per home
Tell the fire service if a firefighting lift is still out	Building safety lead	Day 2, 01:40	OPEN	Notification time recorded
Decide whether a safety occurrence must be reported	Head of housing	Day 2	OPEN	Decision and reasons logged
Close contractors' remote access to plant controls	Facilities and IT	Day 5	BLOCKED	Awaiting contractor; escalated to head of facilities

> Due times are illustrative. Social landlords must investigate and make safe emergency hazards within 24 hours of becoming aware, and in high-rise blocks a firefighting lift fault not fixed in 24 hours must be reported to the fire service.[3,5]

EXERCISE

Tabletop exercise: lights out on the estate

A night-time scenario across three blocks. Run it in the room or on the platform you would use for real, with the clock running.

DURATION	PARTICIPANTS	OBJECTIVE	FACILITATOR
Two and a half hours, including a 30-minute debrief	Duty managers, building safety, welfare, comms, a contractor; invite the fire service liaison	Reach every resident in three blocks and show who has not responded	Someone outside the on-call team, with an observer timing each decision

01:40	INJECT 1	Calls from Blocks A and C: lights out. A BMS alarm shows high temperature in the shared plant room.	DISCUSS Who opens the incident, and at what level? Is this one incident or three?
01:50	INJECT 2	Smoke reported in Block B's basement. The fire service is on its way. Lifts in all three blocks have stopped.	DISCUSS What does each block hear first, and who approves the wording?
02:05	INJECT 3	The incident commander decides to evacuate Block B. Blocks A and C stay put.	DISCUSS How fast does the change reach every Block B resident without confusing A and C?
02:20	INJECT 4	A third of Block B flats have not acknowledged, including three residents on the assistance register.	DISCUSS Who chases, on which channel? What goes to the incident commander, and when?
02:45	INJECT 5	A contractor offers to reset the plant controls remotely. A local reporter calls the out-of-hours line.	DISCUSS Who decides on remote changes? What is recorded first? Who speaks to the media?
03:30	INJECT 6	Power will not return to Block B tonight. Two residents use powered medical equipment.	DISCUSS Who decides on a rest centre or hotels? How do displaced residents stay informed?

> Measure time to declare, time to first message for each block, time to reach every resident on the assistance register, and how many decisions were logged with reasons. Every gap goes on the actions tracker.

REVIEW

Post-incident review template

Hold the review within two weeks, while memories are fresh, and build it from the incident log rather than recollection. Invite the fire service liaison and a resident representative where appropriate.

INCIDENT _____ DATE _____ SEVERITY _____ REVIEW LEAD _____

01 What happened

Timeline from first report to stand-down, block by block, taken from the log.

02 Who was reached, and how fast

Residents messaged, acknowledged and not reached, by block and channel.

03 Residents who need help

Was everyone on the assistance register reached or reported? Anyone missing from it?

04 Decisions and who made them

Severity, strategy change, rest centre, remote changes: who, when, on what information.

05 Where it went wrong

Delays, missed hand-offs, confusing messages, gaps out of hours or with contractors.

06 Contractors and building systems

Who attended, what they changed, and whether settings were recorded before any reset.

07 Duties and reports

Fire service lift notifications, emergency hazard timescales, safety occurrence decision.

08 Actions, owners, dates

Each lesson becomes a tracked action with an owner, a due date and a check.

YOUR PLAN

This week, this month, this quarter

Owners are suggestions. Adjust them to your structure and building portfolio.

WHEN	ACTIONS	OWNER
This week	Check every out-of-hours contact and escalation route. Confirm contractors' 24/7 numbers. Find any BMS, lift or plant controller reachable from the internet.	Duty manager rota lead
This week	Draft and approve the six message templates. Confirm who may send an evacuation message.	Head of housing or facilities
This month	Audit records of residents who may need help: consent, contact preference, flat and floor. Confirm what the fire service holds.	Building safety lead
This month	Remove internet exposure of building controls, change default passwords and agree remote access rules with contractors.	Facilities and IT
This quarter	Run a night-time exercise including a strategy change and a BMS fault. Measure time to reach every resident.	Building safety lead
This quarter	Review Awaab's Law response times, the decision log and, for higher-risk buildings, the residents' engagement strategy.[12] Report to the board.	Director of property

FOR LEADERS

Questions for your leadership team

Ask them out loud. Vague answers are the finding.

REACH

? If we had to evacuate our tallest block tonight, how long would it take to reach every resident, and how would we know who we had missed?

? Do we know, for every building, which residents need help to leave, and does the fire service have that information with their consent?

? Who decides, at 3am, that an incident is SEV 1?

CONTROL AND PROOF

? Which of our building systems can be reached from the internet, and who can change them?

? Could we produce a timed record of every message and decision from our last incident within a day?

? Are we meeting the 24-hour emergency hazard timescale today, and how do we know?

CHECKLIST

Can you reach every resident?

Tick what is true today. Anything blank is your next action.

- [ ] **One out-of-hours route with automatic escalation**
  Tested in the last three months.

- [ ] **Six approved message templates**
  Including a stay put to evacuation change and a holding line.

- [ ] **Consented records of residents who need help**
  With flat, floor, contact preference and review date.

- [ ] **Fire safety instructions issued to every resident**
  To new residents promptly and to everyone every 12 months.[3]

- [ ] **Contractor 24/7 contacts and remote access rules**
  No exposed controllers, no default passwords.

- [ ] **24-hour emergency hazard process**
  Investigation and safety work within 24 hours of becoming aware.[5,13]

- [ ] **Decision log in use**
  Every incident, timestamped, with recipients and acknowledgements.

- [ ] **Night-time exercise in the last year**
  Including vulnerable residents and a strategy change.

GLOSSARY

Words worth knowing

Responsible person
The person with duties under the Fire Safety Order for the common parts of a building, usually the landlord or managing agent.[14]

Accountable person
Under the Building Safety Act, a person who holds a legal estate in, or has a repairing obligation for, any part of the common parts of a higher-risk building.

Higher-risk building
In occupation, a building at least 18 metres or seven storeys tall with at least two residential units.

Stay put
A strategy in which residents not affected by fire or smoke remain in their flats, relying on compartmentation.

Simultaneous evacuation
Everyone leaves at once when the alarm sounds or when told to.

Residential PEEP
A personal emergency evacuation plan for a resident who cannot evacuate unaided, recorded as an emergency evacuation statement.

Secure information box
A box on site holding plans and contact details for the fire and rescue service.

Emergency hazard
Under Awaab's Law, a hazard posing an imminent and significant risk of harm that a reasonable landlord would make safe within 24 hours.

BMS
Building management system: the controls that run heating, ventilation, lighting, pumps and sometimes access and lifts.

Safety occurrence
An incident or situation relating to fire spread or structural integrity in a higher-risk building that must be reported to the regulator.

WHY COORDINATION, NOT JUST NOTIFICATION

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.

When a fire alarm sounds in a high-rise at 02:10, a text to residents is minute one. Keeping everyone safe depends on which residents need help, which contractor is on the way, who changed the evacuation strategy, and a record you can stand behind later.

WHERE INCIDENTS GO WRONG

01	**Fragmented information**	Different teams work from different information.
02	**Delayed decision making**	Leadership lacks visibility, so decisions wait.
03	**Uncoordinated response**	Several teams work independently on the same problem.
04	**Lack of visibility**	Critical actions become difficult to track.
05	**Lack of accountability**	Actions and decisions are poorly documented.

THE WHOLE INCIDENT, IN ONE PLATFORM



> Crises Control is an **Operational Incident Coordination Platform**. It helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform.

THE PLATFORM

One connected platform, from first alert to final report.

Crises Control helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform. Each module does one job; the value comes from how they work together across the incident.

01

ESCALATE

SOS

Frontline staff report an incident in one touch from a mobile device.

02

START

Ping

Alerting and activation: reach people and collect acknowledgements and responses.

03

COORDINATE

Incident Manager

Activate the incident, assign roles, control communication and keep the timeline.

04

EXECUTE

Task Manager

Assign actions, track completion and escalate what stalls, with clear accountability.

05

OPERATE

Control Centre

Real-time view of incidents, timelines, task status and assets.

06

PROVE

Audit & Reporting

Incident records, response analysis and task accountability, ready to report.

07

ASSIST

CRAiG

AI assistant that helps users find information and work through the incident.

THE OUTCOMES

Alerting and activation

Reach the right people immediately.

Operational coordination

Structure communication and response activities.

Execution and visibility

Track tasks, responsibilities and progress.

Proof and accountability

Create a complete, defensible operational record.

Most organisations start with the capability they need today, often alerting, and expand as their requirements mature. Highlighted modules are the ones this playbook draws on.

HOW THE MODULES WORK TOGETHER

How the modules work together in a building emergency

The three-block night incident from this playbook, followed through the platform from the first report to the record you hand the review.

01	ESCALATE **SOS**	A concierge or caretaker raises the alarm in one touch, with the building and floor attached.
02	START **Ping**	Every resident in the affected blocks gets the right stay-put or evacuation message by SMS, voice and push, and silence is chased.
03	COORDINATE **Incident Manager**	The duty manager opens one incident across all three blocks, assigns roles and logs the fire service's strategy decision.
04	EXECUTE **Task Manager**	Welfare calls, door-knocks and contractor call-outs become owned tasks with deadlines that escalate when missed.
05	OPERATE **Control Centre**	The incident lead sees, block by block, which flats are reached, which tasks are open and what has escalated.
06	PROVE **Audit & Reporting**	A timestamped record of every message, acknowledgement and decision is ready for the review, the Ombudsman or the regulator.
07	ASSIST **CRAiG**	Users ask CRAiG to find information in the incident, such as which flats have not yet responded.

COORDINATION
Everyone works from the same incident, roles and log.

VISIBILITY
Leaders see progress without chasing for updates.

EXECUTION
Every action has an owner, a deadline and an escalation.

ACCOUNTABILITY
The record of what happened builds itself as you go.

READINESS ASSESSMENT

How ready is your response?

Score each area from 0 (not in place) to 3 (fully in place) for your property and housing organisation, then add up the total.

AREA	THE QUESTION	SCORE 0 TO 3
01 · ACTIVATION **Alert**	Can you reach the right people on more than one channel within minutes, day or night? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Residents, staff and contractors reached on several channels, including people without smartphones.	0 1 2 3
02 · ACTIVATION **Acknowledge**	Do you know who has seen the alert, and does silence trigger escalation automatically? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Acknowledgement tracked by block and by flat; vulnerable residents followed up first.	0 1 2 3
03 · COORDINATION **Escalate**	Are escalation paths set by role and time, not by whoever remembers who to call? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Out-of-hours escalation to the duty manager and contractor is automatic.	0 1 2 3
04 · COORDINATION **Coordinate**	Is there one shared workspace and log for the incident, not scattered calls, chats and inboxes? GOOD LOOKS LIKE One log for the incident, shared by housing, repairs, the fire service liaison and communications.	0 1 2 3
05 · EXECUTION **Execute**	Are your procedures turned into owned tasks with deadlines that someone can track? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Awaab's Law and fire safety actions run as tasks with owners and deadlines.	0 1 2 3
06 · EXECUTION **See**	Can leaders see tasks, people, locations and blockers live, without having to ask? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A live view of buildings, residents contacted and jobs outstanding.	0 1 2 3
07 · ASSURANCE **Prove**	Could you produce a timestamped timeline for a regulator, insurer or inquiry within a day? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A defensible, timestamped record of every decision and message.	0 1 2 3
08 · ASSURANCE **Rehearse**	Do you exercise the whole response, not just the call tree, at least once a year? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Night-time scenarios rehearsed, including a change from stay put to evacuation.	0 1 2 3

0 to 8
Alerting only
You can send messages. The response still depends on people and luck.

9 to 16
Coordinating in parts
Some steps work. Gaps appear at night, at scale or when systems fail.

17 to 24
Coordinated and provable
You can run the response and show exactly what happened.

BUYER'S GUIDE

Eight questions to ask any incident platform supplier

Many tools can send an alert. These questions separate a notification tool from a platform that coordinates the whole response.

01 **Does it stop at the message?**
Ask what the platform does after the alert is sent: tasks, log, escalation, recovery.

02 **Can it prove who acknowledged?**
Delivery is not acknowledgement. Ask how silence is detected and escalated.

03 **Does it run your procedures?**
Ask whether your plans become owned tasks with deadlines, or stay as documents.

04 **Is there one shared picture?**
Ask what leaders see live, and whether it needs someone to update a spreadsheet.

05 **Does it work when your systems do not?**
Ask how teams coordinate if email, chat or your network is down.

06 **Can frontline staff raise the alarm?**
Ask how a colleague on site escalates, with their location, in one action.

07 **What evidence does it leave behind?**
Ask for a sample timeline of the kind a regulator, insurer or inquiry would want.

08 **Can you rehearse in it?**
Ask whether you can run exercises on the same platform you would use for real.

SOURCES

Sources and notes

Sources were accessed in November 2026. Legal duties are summarised; read the regulations and official guidance for the full requirements. Building and organisation names in the examples are fictional.

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BOOK YOUR PROPERTY, HOUSING AND FACILITIES PLATFORM DEMONSTRATION

Watch a night-time fire run end to end.

A live, 30-minute demonstration built around a property, housing and facilities incident. You will see one incident move through the whole platform, not a tour of features, and you can bring your own scenario.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE

01	SOS	A concierge raises a fire alarm alert from the building, with location.
02	PING	Residents, the duty manager and contractors are alerted; acknowledgements come back by flat.
03	INCIDENT MANAGER	The incident is activated, roles assigned and the evacuation decision logged.
04	TASK MANAGER	Welfare checks for residents with assistance needs become owned tasks.
05	CONTROL CENTRE	The duty manager sees buildings, residents reached and jobs outstanding.
06	AUDIT & REPORTING	A defensible record of every message and decision is produced.
07	CRAIG	CRAiG helps the duty manager find information and guidance in the platform.

Book your demonstration →

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+44 (0) 20 8584 1385 · contactus@crises-control.com

SCAN TO BOOK

COMPANION REPORT Safe homes, clear duties